

championship won by a Chinese team at this year's Esports World Cup.

Chen Yin-hong (ID: QQ), 18, of VKG, was named MVP of the series.



NATIONAL SPORTS POLICY OMITTS ESPORTS

Esports has made inroads into avenues of traditional sports, getting included in the Asian Games and earning recognition by the International Olympic Committee.

But its scene in India suffered a major dent when it was omitted from the National Sports Policy, the Khelo Bharat Niti-2025, released earlier this month.

The policy keeps India's Department of Sports as the nodal agency for esports in the country, without any recognition to the Esports Federation of India.

The Central Government has also made a distinction between competitive gaming — esports — and real money gaming — gambling included — with the latter falling under the purview of India's Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology.

FREE FIRE RETURNS TO INDIA AFTER 3.5 YEARS

Free Fire, once one of India's most popular games, marked its return to the country after three-and-a-half years, with Free Fire MAX India Cup 2025, which will take place from July 13 to September 28.

With a prize pool of ₹1 crore, the tournament will be India's first major competitive roadmap in the game, developed by Garena, since its ban in 2022.

The return is also expected to shake up the competition for MOBA Games in India, with BattleGrounds Mobile India (BGMI), the sole leader in the market, followed by Call of Duty Mobile.

The tournament will run from July 13 to September 28 and will be held in four phases:

In-game Qualifiers: July 13

Online Qualifiers: July 26 – August 3

League Stage: August 22 – September 14

Grand Finals: September 27 – 28

After the In-game qualifiers, 48 teams have qualified for the next round.



Did you know? Wimbledon 2025 semifinalist Taylor Fritz is an Emerald 3 in League of Legends (LoL), ranking him over 80 per cent of the players of the game.

WHO AM I?

I won the PUBG Mobile India Tour in 2019, the PUBG Mobile India Series in 2020, and five additional championships as part of GodLike Esports.

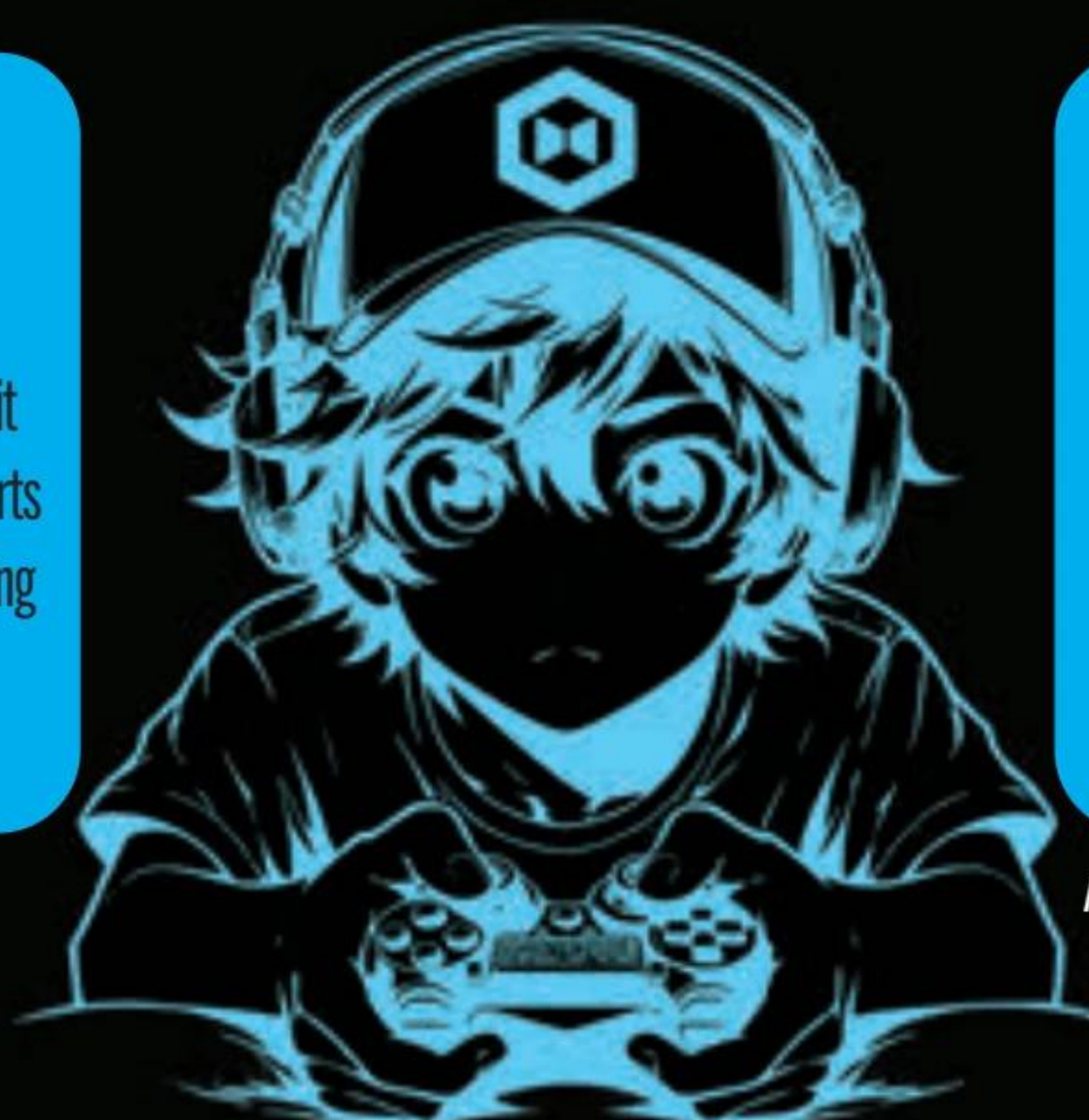
The answer will be revealed in the next issue.

Answer to previous issue's quiz:
Ankit "V3nom" Panth



BUSINESS OF ESPORTS

MSI entered a partnership with Red Bull, where it will incorporate hardware into three of Red Bull's esports tournaments, including Red Bull Home Ground (including European events) and Red Bull Team5.



EASTER EGG 'SCRIM'

Scrim is short for scrimmages. These are practice matches played between two esports teams or individuals as warm-ups before major tournaments.

Rankings and quiz powered by NODWIN Gaming